
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Early Age Machaka

Lion Kings

Progress Edition 31

Working release - 14 September 2026

Unmodded 6.37 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Early Age Machaka: Lion Kings

Early Age Machaka one-page command brief

Early Age Machaka converts totemic human clans, poison archers, spider riders, war lions, elephants, and semi-divine Colossi into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 12 commander identities and 14 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 3 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are mixed recruitment, animal morale, poison exposure, trampling control, and scarce top-end commanders.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

Early Age Machaka evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age Machaka on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 28, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit `cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc`.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any Machaka object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

Early Age Machaka conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

Early Age Machaka recruitment geography

Recruitment layer	Commanders	Troops	Evidence boundary
Ordinary forts	9	10	Direct pinned membership rows
Regional or coastal	0	0	Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent
Site-linked	3	4	Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

Early Age Machaka commander roster

ID	Commander	Fixed and random magic	Leadership
2288	Machaka Scout	none	0
2289	Rhino Clan Commander	none	75
2290	Lion Clan Commander	none	100
4134	Gnu Clan Commander	none	50
2291	Voice of Lion	N1 H1	50
2292	Hyena Clan Witch Doctor	F1 E1 D2	10
2293	Bouda	F1 E2 D2; random: 100% x1 mask 5248 link 1	10
2310	Voice of Spider	none	0
2403	Spider Clan Witch Doctor	F1 D1 N1 G1	10
2295	Spider Clan Sorcerer	F1 D1 N1 G1; random: 100% x2 mask 29824 link 1; 10% x1 mask 29824 link 1	10
2297	Lion Queen	F3 E1 N2 H1; random: 10% x1 mask 9344 link 1	50
2296	Lion King	F2 E1 N3 H2; random: 10% x1 mask 9344 link 1	100

Early Age Machaka troop roster

ID	Unit	HP	Protection	Morale	Traits
2126	Pygmy	4	0	6	ordinary body
2298	Machaka Militia	10	0	8	ordinary body
2299	Bird Clan Archer	10	0	8	ordinary body
2300	Machaka Warrior	10	0	10	ordinary body
2303	Hyena Clan Warrior	11	0	9	ordinary body
2304	Rhino Clan Warrior	13	0	11	ordinary body
2305	Lion Clan Warrior	12	0	12	ordinary body
2306	War Lion	20	4	13	ordinary body
4133	Gnu Clan Cavalry	11	0	12	ordinary body
2307	Elephant Rider	13	0	10	ordinary body
2301	Spider Clan Archer	9	0	8	ordinary body
2302	Spider Clan Warrior	9	0	10	ordinary body
2308	Spider Rider	10	0	10	ordinary body
2309	Lion Warrior	22	1	14	sacred

Early Age Machaka mage and priest portfolio

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The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 3, Earth 2, Death 2, Nature 3, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

Early Age Machaka capital and national sites

ID	Site	Monthly fields	Recruits recorded
153	Forest of Spider	D1, N1, G1	Spider Clan Sorcerer, Spider Clan Archer, Spider Clan Warrior, Spider Rider
154	Great Mababwe	F1, E2	Lion Queen, Lion King, Lion Warrior

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

Early Age Machaka national spell map

ID	Spell	School	Requirement	Cost field
340	Herd of Elephants	Conjuration 3	N2	20
343	Weavers of the Wood	Enchantment 5	N4	6
1473	Herd of Gnus	Conjuration 3	N2	5

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

Early Age Machaka national item boundary

ID	Item	Construction	Paths	Link
177	Totem Shield	5	D1 G1	rebate
197	Spirit Mask	5	D2 N1	rebate
240	Kithaironic Lion Pelt	3	N1 E1	rebate
427	Fever Fetish	9	F1 N1	rebate

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

Early Age Machaka hero boundary

ID	Hero record	Magic	Boundary
952	Hero	none	assignment only; timing unresolved
953	King Triumphant	H3	assignment only; timing unresolved
946	Lady of Spiders	F1 E3 D3 G2	assignment only; timing unresolved
1426	Crowned Ape	H1	assignment only; timing unresolved
1706	Ape Oracle	N1	assignment only; timing unresolved

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

Early Age Machaka army identities

- Sacred roster: Lion Warrior.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: totemic human clans, poison archers, spider riders, war lions, elephants, and semi-divine Colossi.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

Early Age Machaka opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

Early Age Machaka fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For Machaka, the most likely planning failure is mixed recruitment, animal morale, poison exposure, trampling control, and scarce top-end commanders. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

Early Age Machaka research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.

- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

Early Age Machaka magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 3, Earth 2, Death 2, Nature 3, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

Early Age Machaka battlefield packages

Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

Early Age Machaka Pretender families

Family	What it can solve	What it cannot conceal
Missing-path bridge	Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold	Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required
Economy and infrastructure	Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements	Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points
Sacred support	Improves a verified sacred package	Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain

Family	What it can solve	What it cannot conceal
Awake expansion body	Reduces pressure on the starting roster	Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents
Resistance package	Covers a documented roster weakness	One resistance is not universal defence

Early Age Machaka matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Massed light units	Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves	Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage
Heavy armour	Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs	Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided
Accurate missiles	Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption	Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards
Elemental resistance	Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure	Building the complete research plan around one element
Fast raiders or flyers	Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves	Concentrating every commander in one army
Large targets	Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters	Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal
Underwater or land transition	Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies	Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross

Early Age Machaka monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

Early Age Machaka unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

Early Age Machaka source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.

- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: MA Machaka nation pages, national rituals, mounts, forging, and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.36. No undocumented Machaka behaviour is inferred from a negative patch search.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for nation identity, random masks, capital sites, spell restrictions, hero records, and item rebates.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, printed costs, paths, site income, active ritual requirements, and pinned metadata are source facts. Openings, research branches, army packages, Pretender families, and matchup responses are strategy. Expansion counts, live random displays, spider summons, Herd of Gnus availability, Weavers of the Wood outcomes, assassination, stealth, poison, webs, mounts, displayed rebates, hero timing, and combat results remain unresolved.